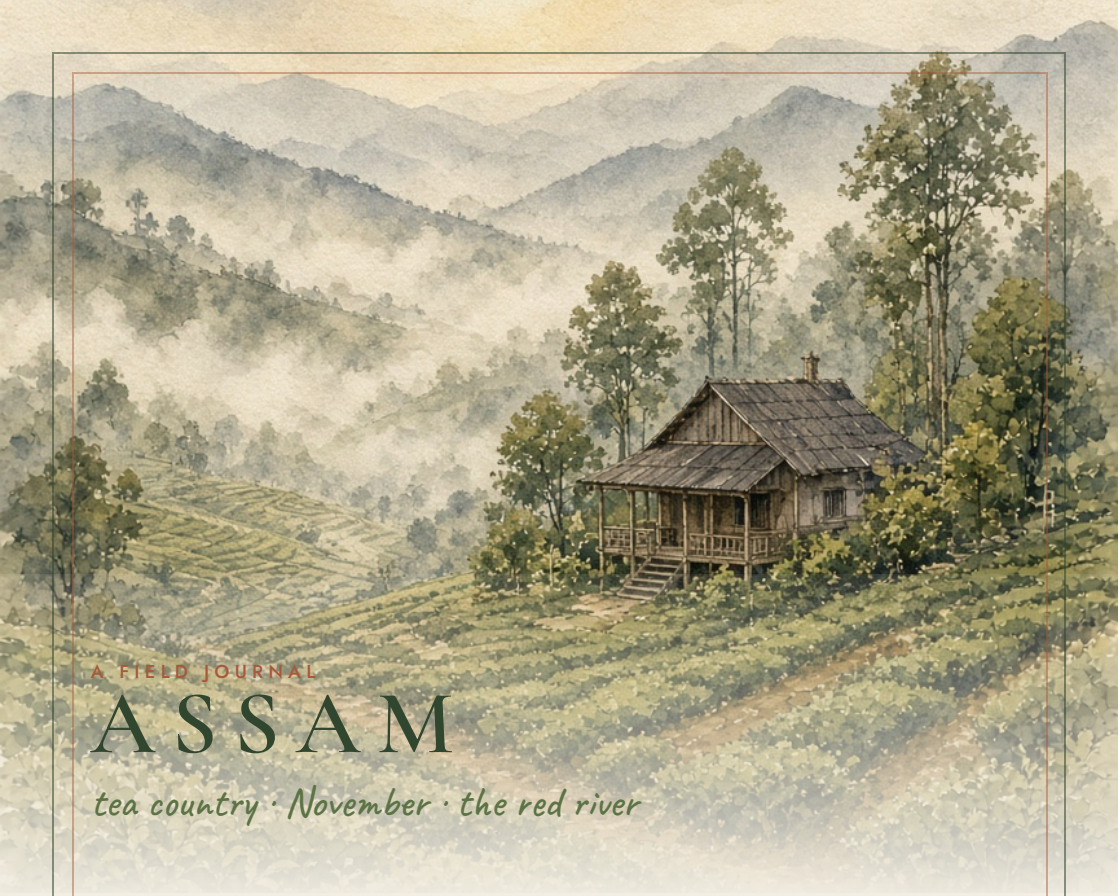


A FIELD JOURNAL

ASSAM

tea country · November · the red river

TRAVELLER

DATES

VISAKHAPATNAM → BHUBANESWAR → GUWAHATI → DURRUNG

Three nights at The Postcard in the Durrung Tea Estate, Tezpur. Airport pickup from GAU · ~216 km · about 4 hours through the Brahmaputra country. Kaziranga booked through the estate.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

Write on the outbound flights. Fill the car window on the road from Guwahati. After each meal, after safari, last night at Durrung, and on the way home. Pencil travels better than ink. Tea stains are allowed.

NOVEMBER

Mornings ~12°C
Afternoons ~25°C
Park open · grass still tall
26.7162°N 92.7278°E

নমস্কাৰ · *in the land of the red river and blue hills*

THE GOING

Vizag to the gardens

Two hops, then a long green road. Record the unremarkable bits. They become the trip.

FLIGHT ONE · VTZ → BBI

NO. _____ SEAT _____

DEP _____ ARR _____

SKY / AIRPORT _____

FLIGHT TWO · BBI → GAU

NO. _____ SEAT _____

DEP _____ ARR _____

FIRST GLIMPSE OF ASSAM FROM THE AIR _____

PICKUP · LOKPRIYA GOPINATH BORDOLOI, GUWAHATI

DRIVER / VEHICLE _____ LEFT AT _____

ARRIVED DURRUNG _____ KM _____

WHAT THE ROAD SHOWED ME

_____

_____

_____

_____

PACK BEFORE YOU LEAVE · NOVEMBER

- ☐ Neutral layers (olive, khaki)
- ☐ Closed shoes
- ☐ Camera + spare battery
- ☐ Hat, sunscreen, insect repellent
- ☐ Light rain shell
- ☐ Warm layer for 5 a.m. safari
- ☐ Binoculars
- ☐ ID for safari permit
- ☐ This journal + pencil
- ☐ Cash for the road

THE STAY · THREE NIGHTS

The Postcard · Durrung

A working estate since 1864 · 1,400 acres between Nameri and the Brahmaputra · twelve rooms. Planter's bungalow or a chang chalet on stilts among the tea.



ROOM · BUNGALOW / CHALET NO.

FIRST CUP AT

HOW THAT FIRST CUP TASTED

DAYS IN THE GARDEN

Day one

MORNING

AFTERNOON

NIGHT

Day two

MORNING

AFTERNOON

NIGHT

Day three

MORNING

AFTERNOON

LEAVING

TEA TASTING

Two leaves and a bud. Write the ones they pour.

DRY LEAF

LIQUOR COLOUR

AROMA

BODY / FINISH

THE CUP I WANT AGAIN

AT THE TABLE

Tick what you ate. Note the one that stays.

- ☐ Masor tenga
- ☐ Khar / xaak
- ☐ Aloo pitika
- ☐ Pitha / jolpaan
- ☐ Joha or boka saul rice
- ☐ Plantation trail / factory

FAVOURITE PLATE

PEOPLE I MET

THE PARK · UNESCO

Kaziranga

Arranged through the estate. Cool, dry November. Grass can still be tall early in the month — look along the beels and the burnt patches. Neutral clothes. No calling to animals. Let the jeep stop for you.

SAFARI ONE

DATE / AM · PM

JEEP / ELEPHANT

RANGE · KOHORA · BAGORI · AGARATOLI · BURAPAHAR

GUIDE / VEHICLE

SEEN · TICK IN THE FIELD

- ☐ One-horned rhino
- ☐ Wild water buffalo
- ☐ Hog deer
- ☐ Wild boar
- ☐ Hoolock gibbon
- ☐ Asian elephant
- ☐ Swamp deer
- ☐ Sambar
- ☐ Otter
- ☐ Tiger · lucky day

BIRDS

THE MOMENT I WILL REMEMBER

SAFARI TWO · IF YOU GO AGAIN

DATE / AM · PM

JEEP / ELEPHANT

RANGE

GUIDE / VEHICLE



sketch a horn, a beel, a silhouette in grass

SLOWER NOTES

What the estate kept

Fill this on a quiet afternoon. Pool, library, bungalow verandah, or the deck of the chalet.

SOUNDS

MORNING

NOON

NIGHT · THE ESTATE SITS ON AN ELEPHANT CORRIDOR

WEATHER

DAY 1

DAY 2

DAY 3

I DID NOT EXPECT

ASSAMESE I USED

নমস্কাৰ	Nomoskar	*hello*
ধন্যবাদ	Dhanyabad	*thank you*
চাহ	Sah / cha	*tea*
বহুত ভাল	Bohut bhal	*very good*
word I learned		*meaning*
word I learned		*meaning*

A LEAF, A STAMP, A SMALL THING PRESSED HERE

tape a tea leaf, a gamosa thread, a boarding pass stub

THE RETURN

Homeward

Estate drop to Guwahati, then the same sky in reverse. Write before the trip becomes a story you tidy.

DURRUNG → GAU

LEFT AT _____ REACHED AIRPORT _____

LAST LOOK AT THE GARDENS _____

GAU → BBI → VTZ

FLIGHT · SEAT _____ FLIGHT · SEAT _____

WHAT I CARRIED BACK THAT IS NOT IN A BAG _____

THREE THINGS I WILL KEEP

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

A NOTE TO MYSELF IN SIX MONTHS

_____

_____

_____

_____

TEA TO PACK

_____

_____

THANK YOU, SAID TO

_____

_____



MADE FOR A NOVEMBER JOURNEY · VISAKHAPATNAM TO ASSAM · DURRUNG TEA ESTATE · KAZIRANGA